

Seawall height in Hollywood

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

HOLLYWOOD • BROWARD COUNTY

5.0

ft NAVD88 (4.0 if applied for before 2035)

Hollywood's minimum is 5 ft NAVD88. An application filed before 1 January 2035 may be permitted at 4 ft NAVD88, but only if the barrier is designed and built to reach 5 ft NAVD88 by 1 January 2050. The rule is in the city's own code, Sec. 150.30, adopted by Ordinance O-2022-01 on 2 February 2022, and follows Broward County Code Sec. 39-407.

The detail

MINIMUM	5 ft NAVD88 for new, substantially repaired or substantially rehabilitated tidal flood barriers. Hollywood Code Sec. 150.30(D)(1).
THE 2035 ALLOWANCE	Applications submitted before 1 January 2035 may be permitted at 4 ft NAVD88 if designed and constructed to accommodate 5 ft NAVD88 by 1 January 2050. The code says may, so it is not an entitlement. Sec. 150.30(D)(1).
WHAT COUNTS AS SUBSTANTIAL	One complete project that modifies more than 50% of the property's shoreline, or work on an attached structure such as a dock costing more than 50% of a new tidal flood barrier along the shoreline, as determined by the City Engineer. Sec. 150.30(C).
THE WHOLE SHORELINE, WITH RETURNS	A substantially repaired barrier must run along the property's entire tidally influenced shoreline. Where it cannot adjoin the neighbours' barriers, return structures are required to stop flanking. Sec. 150.30(D)(5)-(6).
RIPRAP BY THE YARD	At least one cubic yard per linear foot of natural limerock riprap, or other approved habitat enhancement, at the waterward face. Sec. 150.30(D)(7).
LIVING SHORELINES COUNT	Provided the landside edge is substantially impermeable and built to the minimum elevation. Sec. 150.30(C), (D)(8).
THE REPAIR CLOCK	After a citation, 60 days to show progress and 365 days to complete. Sec. 150.30(D)(2)-(3).
A REVIEW DATE IN THE CODE	The city must re-evaluate the 5 ft standard in 2034 or before, against updated sea level projections. Sec. 150.30(A)(3).

DISCLOSURE WHEN YOU SELL	Sale contracts for property in a tidally influenced area must carry the tidal flood barrier disclosure in capitalised bold type of at least 14 point. Sec. 150.30(E).
NO PERMIT WITHOUT IT	No building permit to build, rebuild, structurally alter or repair a waterfront retaining wall unless the subchapter is met. Sec. 150.23.
WHERE IT DOES NOT APPLY	Oceanfront beaches and shorelines seaward of the Coastal Construction Control Line. Sec. 150.30(B).

Where this comes from: City of Hollywood Code of Ordinances Secs. 150.23 and 150.30, Resiliency Standards for Tidal Flood Barriers (Ord. O-2022-01, passed 2-2-22; American Legal Publishing); Broward County Code Ch. 39, Art. XXV, Sec. 39-407 (Ord. No. 2020-11)

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.